Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Semicolons: Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The sky darkened. The storm was near.'

Answer: 'The sky darkened; the storm was near.' — a semicolon joins two closely related main clauses that could each stand alone.

Colons: Add a colon to introduce this list: 'The bag contained three things a torch, a map and some rope.'

Answer: 'The bag contained three things: a torch, a map and some rope.' — a colon introduces a list, explanation or example.

Direct speech: Punctuate this direct speech correctly: 'Watch out shouted Leo'

Answer: '"Watch out!" shouted Leo.' — speech marks around the exact words, an exclamation mark inside them, and a lower-case reporting clause after.

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The rain stopped. The sun came out.'
2. Add a colon to introduce the list: 'We need these items a pencil a rubber and a ruler.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech? A) Tom said, I am ready. B) Tom said, "I am ready." C) Tom said "I am ready" D) "Tom said I am ready." E) Tom said: I am ready.
4. Add brackets to insert this extra detail: 'My cousin born in 2014 loves football.'
5. Underline the correct use of a dash in: 'The trip — though tiring — was wonderful.'
6. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'Can we go now asked Ben'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a colon to introduce a list? A) She packed: a hat, gloves and a scarf. B) She packed a hat: gloves and a scarf. C) She needed three things: time, money and patience. D) She needed: three things. E) The winners were: Alex, Sam and Mo.
8. Which punctuation mark correctly joins these two related sentences: 'He was exhausted ___ he had run ten miles.'? A) comma B) colon C) semicolon D) dash E) full stop with no change
9. Add speech marks to: Stop right there! yelled the guard.
10. Explain what a colon does before a list, using the sentence: 'Bring the following: wellies, a coat and an umbrella.'
11. Which sentence correctly uses a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The lights went out; because of the storm. B) The lights went out, the storm was fierce. C) The lights went out; the storm was fierce. D) The lights went out: the storm was fierce. E) The lights went out the storm was fierce.
12. Punctuate this sentence with brackets around the extra information: 'The museum which opens at nine is free today.'
13. Write a short sentence of direct speech with the reporting clause BEFORE the speech, punctuated correctly.

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14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate a dash used to add an afterthought? A) The match was close — until the final minute. B) The match was close, until the final minute —. C) The match was close — until the final minute. D) The — match was close until the final minute. E) The game ended in a draw — a fair result.

15. Explain why 'He said "hello"' is missing a capital letter and a full stop, and correct it.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Join these two related sentences using a semicolon: 'The exam was difficult. Most pupils still passed.'

2. Add a colon to this sentence: 'There was only one explanation he had forgotten his key.'

3. Which sentence correctly punctuates a piece of direct speech split by a reporting clause? A) "I think," said Mia, "we should leave now." B) "I think" said Mia "we should leave now." C) "I think, said Mia, we should leave now." D) I think, said Mia, "we should leave now." E) "I think said Mia we should leave now."

4. Insert dashes to add this extra comment: 'The weather forecast and it is rarely wrong predicted snow.'

5. Explain the difference between using a comma and using a semicolon to join two main clauses, with an example of each.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use brackets for extra (removable) information? A) The bridge (built in 1920) is still standing. B) The bridge built in 1920 (is still standing.) C) The recipe (serves four) takes an hour. D) (The recipe serves four) takes an hour. E) Our teacher (Mr Hughes) is very strict.

7. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'I cannot believe it she whispered we actually won'

8. Which punctuation mark best replaces the gap: 'The verdict was clear ___ the defendant was innocent.'? A) comma B) colon C) apostrophe D) exclamation mark E) hyphen

9. Explain when you would choose a dash rather than a colon to introduce extra information, giving one example of each.

10. Rewrite this sentence using a semicolon instead of 'and': 'The team trained hard, and they deserved to win.'

11. Which sentence correctly punctuates a question within direct speech? A) She asked, "Are we late?" B) She asked "Are we late"? C) She asked, "Are we late"? D) She asked: "Are we late?" E) She asked, Are we late?

12. Add a colon to introduce an explanation in: 'There was a simple reason for his lateness the bus never arrived.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly use a semicolon rather than a comma to join two independent clauses? A) She loves reading; he prefers films. B) She loves reading, he prefers films. C) It was cold; we still went outside. D) It was cold, we still went outside. E) The shop closed early; customers were disappointed.

14. Write one sentence that correctly uses a colon to introduce a single dramatic statement (not a list).

15. Explain why brackets, dashes and commas can all sometimes be used to mark off the same piece of extra information, giving one sentence punctuated three different ways.

Red — Challenge (15 questions)

1. Punctuate this direct speech exchange correctly, including both speakers: Are you coming asked Zara I will be there in a minute replied Josh

2. Explain the difference between how a semicolon and a colon each connect two parts of a sentence, giving one original example of each.

3. Which sentence correctly uses a colon before a list that is introduced by a complete independent clause? A) My favourite sports are: football, tennis and swimming. B) I enjoy: football, tennis and swimming. C) My favourite sports are these: football, tennis and swimming. D) Sports I enjoy football, tennis and swimming. E) I enjoy football: tennis and swimming.

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4. Correct this sentence, which has one missing colon and one misplaced comma: 'The recipe needs just one thing, patience and plenty of it.'

5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following correctly use a semicolon to join two closely related independent clauses? A) The bridge was closed; traffic was diverted. B) The bridge was closed, traffic was diverted. C) Some pupils chose art; others chose drama. D) Some pupils chose art, others chose drama. E) It rained all day; the match still went ahead.

6. Write a sentence containing direct speech interrupted by a reporting clause, where the speech continues as a NEW sentence after the reporting clause. Punctuate it fully and correctly.

7. Which sentence below correctly uses a pair of dashes to mark off a strongly emphasised interruption? A) The result — incredibly was a tie. B) The result incredibly — was a tie. C) The result — incredibly — was a tie. D) The — result incredibly was a tie —. E) The result incredibly was — a tie.

8. Explain why 'The treasure chest held something incredible: gold coins.' uses a colon rather than a semicolon, referring to the rule about what a colon introduces.

9. Correct this passage, which has two punctuation errors (one missing colon, one missing closing speech mark): "I have found the answer, she exclaimed. It was hidden in the attic the whole time.

10. Which sentence correctly combines a colon AND a semicolon in the same sentence? A) He had one goal: to win; nothing else mattered. B) He had one goal to win: nothing else mattered; C) He had one goal; to win: nothing else mattered. D) He had one goal to win, nothing else mattered; E) He had one goal: to win, nothing else mattered.

11. Explain the difference in formality between using a dash and using brackets for the same piece of extra information, giving one example sentence punctuated both ways.

12. Rewrite this sentence, replacing the comma splice with either a semicolon or a full stop and capital letter: 'The fire alarm rang, everyone evacuated calmly.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate direct speech that ends with the reporting clause AFTER a question? A) "Why are we stopping?" asked Dev. B) "Why are we stopping" asked Dev? C) "Why are we stopping," asked Dev? D) "Why are we stopping?", asked Dev. E) "Why are we stopping?" Dev asked.

14. Write one sentence that uses BOTH a pair of brackets for extra information AND a colon to introduce a short list.

15. Explain why the sentence 'He shouted, "Run" and then disappeared.' is missing punctuation after 'Run', and correct it fully.

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